

What Do You Want to Be When You Grow Up?

very expensive city along with the \$30,000 in student loans she had started repaying.

Since her beat was “education,” she decided to write a story which compared average salaries for different jobs. The median salary for her profession “journalism” was \$41,900, about equal to what a social worker earns. Joan was surprised by many of her findings when she did a random sampling from the Department of Labor’s statistics:

Occupation	Average Annual Salary
Postsecondary Teachers	\$64,610
Operations Managers	\$99,280
Elementary School Teachers	\$48,700
Accountants/ Auditors	\$60,670
Computer Software Engineers	\$82,000
Physicians/ Surgeons	\$142,220
Network Systems Analysts	\$67,460
Police Officer	\$48,410
Lawyers	\$113,660
Cooks, restaurant	\$21,020
Fishing Workers	\$28,510
Child Social Workers	\$40,640
Personal Finance Advisors	\$86,730
Radio Announcer	\$36,120
Funeral Director	\$57,250

For her story, Joan interviewed a young woman, Claire, who had graduated from law school two years earlier. After receiving her law degree, Claire promptly took the bar exam and flunked it. While she studied to prepare for her second attempt, she worked as a paralegal. While “lawyer” was the second-highest paying profession Joan’s earning list at an average salary of \$113,660, Claire’s legal assistant job only paid her \$45,460.

